

Projected Precipitation Extremes over Uttaradit Province under CMIP6 SSP Scenarios

Surasit Punyawansiri^{1,*}

*¹Office of Water Management and Hydrology, Royal Irrigation Department, Dusit, Bangkok,
Thailand*

*Corresponding author: Surasit.pu@ku.th

Abstract

Projected changes in precipitation extremes were assessed for Uttaradit Province, northern Thailand, using daily series at 13 rain gauges from seven bias-corrected Coupled Model Intercomparison Project Phase 6 (CMIP6) models under SSP2-4.5 and SSP5-8.5. Eleven annual indices were calculated for 2021–2050 and compared with each model’s 1995–2014 baseline. A model-first scheme summarized station medians within each model before estimating the seven-model median, interquartile range, range, and sign agreement. Station-referenced inverse-distance weighting described spatial contrasts in annual total wet-day precipitation (PRCPTOT). Under SSP2-4.5, median changes were +2.9% for PRCPTOT, +6.1% for maximum 1-day precipitation (Rx1day), +4.2% for maximum 5-day precipitation (Rx5day), and +26.7% for extremely wet-day precipitation (R99p). All seven models indicated increases in Rx1day and R99p, and six indicated higher Rx5day. Under SSP5-8.5, corresponding medians were +0.9%, +12.3%, +2.9%, and +14.4%, respectively, although model ranges crossed zero. PRCPTOT changes were weakly positive at most stations, with localized negative areas under both scenarios. The results suggest possible intensification of short-duration and upper-tail rainfall without a comparably robust increase in annual total. Wide inter-model spread, model non-independence, and the descriptive nature of the spatial interpolation limit deterministic interpretation.

Keywords: precipitation extremes; climate projections; CMIP6; SSP scenarios; Uttaradit Province; model uncertainty

Highlights

- Seven CMIP6 models projected near-term extremes at 13 rain gauges.
- Rx1day increased in all models under SSP2-4.5.
- R99p median change reached 26.7%, but model spread was wide.
- PRCPTOT change was weakly positive with local negative pockets.
- IDW maps depict station contrast, not gridded climate forecasts.

1. Introduction

Precipitation extremes influence flood generation, soil erosion, reservoir operation, agricultural water demand, and drought exposure. A warmer atmosphere can hold more moisture, but regional circulation and monsoon variability determine whether this thermodynamic potential appears as higher event intensity, altered wet-day frequency, or longer dry and wet spells. Consequently, changes in annual precipitation totals alone do not describe the full hydroclimatic response (Alexander et al., 2006; Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, 2021; Zhang et al., 2011). A coordinated set of intensity, duration, frequency, and percentile-based indices is therefore required to identify potentially important changes in both rainfall accumulation and distribution.

The Coupled Model Intercomparison Project Phase 6 (CMIP6) and Scenario Model Intercomparison Project provide a common experimental framework for assessing future climate under alternative forcing pathways (Eyring et al., 2016; O'Neill et al., 2016; Riahi et al., 2017; Tebaldi et al., 2021). Multi-model ensembles allow structural differences among models to be displayed, but their members are neither independent nor equally credible at every location. Ensemble summaries should therefore be interpreted as descriptive evidence conditioned on the selected models, scenarios, and processing chain, rather than as calibrated probabilities (Knutti et al., 2017; Sillmann et al., 2013a; Sillmann et al., 2013b). This issue is particularly important for precipitation tails, where model spread and small baseline values can produce large relative changes.

Local applications also depend on downscaling and bias correction. These procedures can improve the representation of observed distributions, but they may alter temporal dependence, wet-day occurrence, and event sequencing if not evaluated for the target statistic (Cannon et al., 2015; Maraun, 2016; Maraun et al., 2017). Regional studies over Southeast Asia and Thailand indicate spatially heterogeneous future rainfall extremes, substantial inter-model spread, and sensitivity to model or method selection (Humphries et al., 2024; Kuinkel et al., 2024; Nontikansak et al., 2022; Try and Qin, 2024; Waqas and Humphries, 2025; Zhang et al., 2024). Recent observational syntheses likewise show that Thai rainfall variability cannot be represented by one national trend (Chaiwino et al., 2025; de Oliveira-Júnior et al., 2025; Madolli et al., 2025). Province-scale, station-referenced evidence remains useful for planning when its uncertainty and spatial support are stated explicitly.

Uttaradit Province lies in upper northern Thailand and contains a rain-gauge network spanning low-elevation and upland settings. The available projections support a near-term comparison for 2021–2050, a period directly relevant to infrastructure and water-management decisions. However, a defensible provincial assessment must preserve station-

level information, apply a consistent historical baseline within each model, and distinguish spatial visualization from independently validated gridded projection.

This study evaluated projected changes in 11 annual precipitation-extreme indices at 13 stations in Uttaradit Province under SSP2-4.5 and SSP5-8.5. The objectives were to (1) quantify model-first changes for 2021–2050 relative to 1995–2014, including interquartile range, full model range, and sign agreement; (2) describe the spatial pattern of station-level PRCPTOT changes using inverse-distance weighting (IDW); and (3) provide concise observational and future-window trend diagnostics without conflating them with baseline-to-future climatological change. The primary contribution is a transparent, projection-focused synthesis in which ensemble spread and limits of spatial inference are treated as results rather than ancillary qualifications.

2. Methodology

2.1 Study area and data

The analysis used 13 rain gauges distributed across Uttaradit Province (Figure 1 and Table 1). Station coordinates ranged from 17.2300°N to 18.0200°N and from 100.0500°E to 101.0700°E; supplied station elevations ranged from 54.57 to 427.85 m MSL. Coordinates used for analysis were read directly from the validated station input. Elevation was retained as descriptive metadata and did not enter the statistical or IDW calculations.

Table 1. Rain-gauge stations used in the Uttaradit analysis.

Station ID	Latitude (°N)	Longitude (°E)	Elevation (m MSL)
351001	17.2300	100.1000	54.57
351002	17.4200	100.1300	62.02
351003	17.6700	100.6800	371.77
351004	17.6500	100.3800	115.76
351005	17.6000	100.0500	81.47
351006	17.9200	100.8800	348.79
351007	18.0200	101.0700	427.85
351008	17.4700	100.3700	82.43
351009	17.7500	100.2800	95.27
351010	17.9000	100.8200	214.69
351011	17.5600	100.1100	65.37
351012	17.7500	100.9200	415.07
351201	17.6200	100.1000	67.05

Note: Station IDs and coordinates are the inputs used in the analysis. Elevation is supplied station metadata and was not used to calculate the indices, trends, changes, or IDW weights. Station names were not created because the analytical input identifies gauges by ID only.

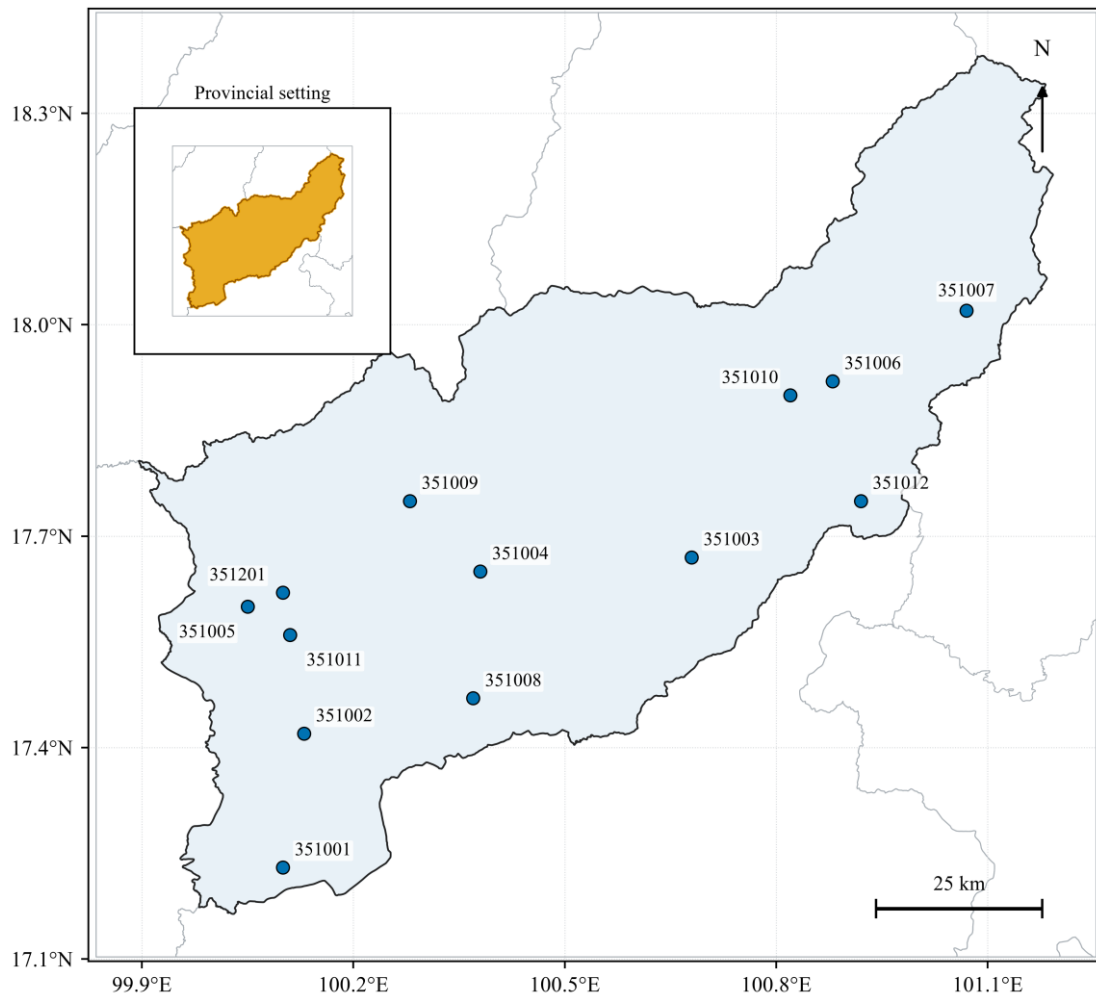


Figure 1. Location of Uttaradit Province and the 13 rain gauges used in the analysis. The inset identifies the province within Thailand. Station labels are gauge IDs; no station names were inferred.

The observed input comprised daily precipitation from 1 January 1981 to 31 December 2014. Seven supplied bias-corrected CMIP6 daily precipitation series were analyzed (Table 2). For each model, 1995–2014 was used as the model-consistent historical baseline and 2021–2050 as the future period. The two scenarios were SSP2-4.5 and SSP5-8.5. The file inventory included one ensemble member and native or regridded grid label per model. Because the supplied daily files did not contain complete metadata for the preceding bias-correction implementation, that procedure was neither reconstructed nor independently validated; all conclusions are conditional on the supplied corrected series.

Table 2. CMIP6 global climate models used in the study.

Model	Institution/consortium	Country/region	Member/grid	Data used
ACCESS-ESM1-5	CSIRO and ARCCSS	Australia	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
CanESM5	CCCma	Canada	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
CESM2	NCAR	United States	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
EC-Earth3	EC-Earth Consortium	Europe	rlilp1fl / gr	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
FGOALS-g3	IAP, Chinese Academy of Sciences	China	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
MIROC6	MIROC Consortium	Japan	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5
MRI-ESM2-0	Meteorological Research Institute	Japan	rlilp1fl / gn	Baseline; SSP2-4.5; SSP5-8.5

Note: Historical data for 1995–2014 provided the model-consistent baseline, and SSP2-4.5 and SSP5-8.5 data for 2021–2050 provided the future period. Daily files were supplied as bias-corrected series; the correction procedure was not re-estimated or independently validated in this study.

2.2 Precipitation indices and quality control

Eleven annual precipitation indices represented wet-day amount and intensity, annual maxima, spell duration, fixed-threshold frequency, and percentile exceedance totals (Table 3). These follow the Expert Team on Climate Change Detection and Indices framework except R50mm, which is a study-specific fixed-threshold count (Alexander et al., 2006; Zhang et al., 2011). A wet day was defined as daily precipitation $RR \geq 1$ mm. The station-specific 95th- and 99th-percentile thresholds were estimated from all observed wet days during 1981–2014 and held fixed for observed and model calculations. This fixed-reference construction prevents the percentile threshold itself from changing between periods.

Table 3. Definitions of precipitation-extreme indices.

Index	Name	Operational definition	Unit
PRCPTOT	Annual total wet-day precipitation	Sum of RR on days with $RR \geq 1$ mm	mm
SDII	Simple daily intensity index	PRCPTOT divided by the number of wet days	mm/day
Rx1day	Maximum 1-day precipitation	Annual maximum 1-day precipitation	mm
Rx5day	Maximum 5-day precipitation	Annual maximum consecutive 5-day precipitation total	mm
CDD	Consecutive dry days	Maximum consecutive days with $RR < 1$ mm	days
CWD	Consecutive wet days	Maximum consecutive days with $RR \geq 1$ mm	days
R10mm	Heavy precipitation days	Number of days with $RR \geq 10$ mm	days
R20mm	Very heavy precipitation days	Number of days with $RR \geq 20$ mm	days
R50mm	Extremely heavy precipitation days	Number of days with $RR \geq 50$ mm	days
R95p	Very wet-day precipitation	Annual precipitation total from wet days exceeding the fixed station P95 threshold	mm
R99p	Extremely wet-day precipitation	Annual precipitation total from wet days exceeding the fixed station P99 threshold	mm

Note: RR denotes daily precipitation. A wet day was $RR \geq 1$ mm. Station-specific P95 and P99 thresholds were estimated from observed wet days during 1981–2014 and then held fixed. R50mm is a study-specific fixed-threshold index.

Daily records were converted to numeric values after explicit removal of predefined missing-value flags. Invalid dates, duplicate dates, negative precipitation, duplicate normalized station IDs, and nonnumeric values were rejected rather than silently repaired. Each series was reindexed to the complete Gregorian calendar. No missing precipitation was imputed; a missing date interrupted a consecutive spell and invalidated any five-day window containing it. An annual index was retained only when at least 90% of calendar days were valid. All 442 observed station-years and all 5,460 future station-model-scenario-years passed this criterion. The minimum completeness was 100% for observations and 99.73% for model series. The resulting data contained 4,862 observed and 60,060 future annual-index values. Observed station thresholds ranged from 12.700 to 43.370 mm for P95 and from 19.723 to 89.553 mm for P99.

2.3 Trend inference and multiplicity

The standard two-sided Mann–Kendall (MK) test was the primary trend inference for the 1981–2014 observed annual series (Mann, 1945). For n observations, the score S was calculated by Equation 1, with ties included in the variance in Equation 2. The continuity-corrected standardized statistic in Equation 3 was evaluated against the standard normal distribution at $\alpha=0.05$.

$$S = \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} \sum_{l=k+1}^n \text{sgn}(x_l - x_k) \quad (1)$$

$$\text{Var}(S) = [n(n-1)(2n+5) - \sum_t t(t-1)(2t+5)] / 18 \quad (2)$$

$$Z = (S-1)/\sqrt{\text{Var}(S)}, S > 0; Z = 0, S = 0; Z = (S+1)/\sqrt{\text{Var}(S)}, S < 0 \quad (3)$$

Trend magnitude was estimated with Sen's median pairwise slope (Equation 4), where t denotes year (Sen, 1968). Because 13 stations and 11 indices produced 143 simultaneous observed tests, the Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery-rate (BH-FDR) procedure was applied as one family at $q=0.05$. Ordered p -values were compared with the criterion in Equation 5, where $m=143$ and k is the largest passing rank (Benjamini and Hochberg, 1995). Both unadjusted MK counts and BH-FDR-retained counts were reported so that multiplicity control is transparent.

$$\hat{\beta} = \text{median}_k <_l [(x_l - x_k)/(t_l - t_k)] \quad (4)$$

$$p_{(k)} \leq (k/m)q \quad (5)$$

Serial dependence was examined using the Yue–Wang detrended effective-sample-size formulation as a sensitivity diagnostic, not as the primary decision rule (Yue and Wang, 2004). After removal of the Sen trend, the full-lag factor and adjusted variance were calculated by Equation 6. This implementation differs from the rank-autocorrelation modification of Hamed and Rao (1998). Factors below one occurred frequently in the short annual series and can reduce the variance; therefore, sensitivity-test significance was not interpreted as confirmatory evidence.

$$n/n^* = 1 + 2\sum_{h=1}^{n-1} (1 - h/n)\rho_h; \text{Var}^*(S) = \text{Var}(S)(n/n^*) \quad (6)$$

2.4 Projection-change aggregation

For model m , scenario s , index i , and station j , the relative change compared the future-period mean with the same model's historical mean (Equation 7). Using a model-consistent baseline avoids combining observed and modeled climatologies in the denominator. If the baseline mean was zero, relative change was undefined and recorded as missing; no arbitrary denominator or offset was introduced. This occurred for R99p at station 351011 in seven models under both scenarios (14 station-level rows). Those values were excluded from the relevant station-median calculation, leaving 12 stations for each model's R99p summary.

$$\Delta_{m, s, i, j} = 100(\bar{X}F_{m, s, i, j} - \bar{X}B_{m, i, j}) / \bar{X}B_{m, i, j} \quad (7)$$

Aggregation was model-first. Equation 8 took the median across stations within each model. Equation 9 then took the median across the seven model-level values; the interquartile range (IQR), full range, and counts of positive, negative, and zero model medians were calculated from the same seven values. This order gives every model one contribution to the ensemble summary, regardless of the magnitude of its within-province spatial variation. The seven-model median is a descriptive measure of central tendency and not an estimate of event probability or formal model independence.

$$D_{m, s, i} = \text{median}_{j=1, \dots, J} (\Delta_{m, s, i, j}) \quad (8)$$

$$\tilde{D}_{s, i} = \text{median}_{m=1, \dots, M} (D_{m, s, i}), \quad M = 7 \quad (9)$$

A standard MK test was also applied separately to each 2021–2050 model–station–scenario–index annual series. These 2,002 tests were retained only as unadjusted within-window diagnostics. They answer whether an index changed monotonically during 2021–2050, whereas Equations 7–9 answer whether its future climatological level differed from the 1995–2014 baseline. No field-significance claim was made from the diagnostic counts.

2.5 Spatial depiction

For PRCPTOT, the relative change was first summarized as the median across seven models at each station and scenario. IDW with power $p=2$ was then applied using great-circle distances in kilometers (Equation 10), where z_j is the station value and d_j is its distance to an interpolation point (Shepard, 1968). The surface was evaluated on a regular grid and clipped to the Uttaradit provincial polygon. The same symmetric percentage scale was used for both scenarios. Values outside the station convex hull, including the far northern part of the polygon, are spatial extrapolations. The maps are descriptive station-referenced depictions, not dynamically downscaled or independently validated continuous-resolution climate projections.

$$\hat{z}(x) = [\sum_{j=1}^J z_j d_j(x)^{-p}] / [\sum_{j=1}^J d_j(x)^{-p}], \quad p = 2 \quad (10)$$

3. Results and Discussion

3.1 Data readiness and historical context

Quality control retained the complete intended station network and all required model–scenario files. The standard MK test identified significant trends in 30 of 143 observed station–index series; BH-FDR retained 14. No station showed a significant PRCPTOT trend by either decision rule, and the station-median Sen slope was -6.75 mm/decade (Table 4). The BH-FDR results were spatially heterogeneous: retained changes included three decreases in CDD, three R50mm changes in opposing directions, and mixed R95p and R99p directions. The observed period therefore provides local context but does not establish a uniform historical trajectory from which future changes can be extrapolated.

Table 4. Observed precipitation-index trends at 13 stations during 1981–2014.

Index	Unit	MK inc.	MK dec.	MK NS	BH inc.	BH dec.	Median Sen slope/decade
PRCPTOT	mm	0	0	13	0	0	-6.75
SDII	mm/day	2	2	9	2	1	-0.09
Rx1day	mm	3	1	9	1	0	0.44
Rx5day	mm	1	1	11	0	0	0.47
CDD	days	1	3	9	0	3	-0.67
CWD	days	2	2	9	1	0	0.00
R10mm	days	0	1	12	0	0	0.00
R20mm	days	2	1	10	0	0	0.00
R50mm	days	2	1	10	2	1	0.00
R95p	mm	1	1	11	0	1	-0.28
R99p	mm	2	1	10	1	1	0.00

Note: MK inc., MK dec., and MK NS are counts from the standard two-sided Mann–Kendall test at $\alpha=0.05$. BH inc. and BH dec. are counts retained after Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery-rate control across all 143 station–index tests. Sen slopes retain the index unit per decade.

3.2 Projected changes across precipitation indices

The model-first ensemble showed that projected changes in event maxima and upper-tail totals were generally larger than the change in annual wet-day precipitation (Table 5 and Figure 2). Under SSP2-4.5, the median PRCPTOT change was +2.9% (IQR –4.0% to +4.9%; range –5.4% to +18.1%), with four model medians positive and three negative. By contrast, Rx1day increased by a median of 6.1% (IQR +0.5% to +15.4%) and R99p by 26.7% (IQR +13.7% to +33.5%); all seven model-level medians were positive for both indices. Rx5day increased by 4.2%, with six of seven models positive. These sign patterns provide stronger ensemble evidence for intensified short-duration and upper-tail precipitation than for a uniform increase in annual total.

Under SSP5-8.5, median PRCPTOT change remained weakly positive at +0.9% (IQR –5.0% to +5.5%; range –9.9% to +15.3%), again with a four-to-three split in sign. Rx1day had the largest scenario amplification among the headline indices, with a median increase of 12.3% compared with 6.1% under SSP2-4.5. Nevertheless, its model range extended from –10.6% to +23.4%, and only five models were positive. Median changes in Rx5day and R99p were +2.9% and +14.4%, respectively, but their IQRs crossed zero and sign agreement weakened to five of seven and four of seven models. The higher forcing scenario therefore did not yield a uniformly larger median response across all indices.

The remaining indices reinforced the mixed character of the projections. Under SSP2-4.5, CDD had a median change of –2.1% with six models negative, while R10mm and R20mm had small negative medians of –0.9% and –2.6%. R50mm increased by a median of 24.4%, and R95p by 4.5%, but their ranges crossed zero. Under SSP5-8.5, median changes were –2.4% for SDII, –3.0% for R10mm, –3.1% for R20mm, +17.5% for R50mm, and +4.3% for R95p. R50mm and R99p displayed particularly broad ranges because rare-event totals or counts can have small baseline means. Their percentage changes should therefore be read together with ensemble spread rather than treated as typical deterministic outcomes.

Table 5. Model-first relative changes in annual precipitation indices for 2021–2050 relative to 1995–2014.

Scenario	Index	Median (%)	IQR (%)	Range (%)	Models +/-/0
SSP2-4.5	PRCPTOT	2.9	–4.0 to 4.9	–5.4 to 18.1	4/3/0
SSP2-4.5	SDII	0.8	–1.7 to 3.4	–3.8 to 11.3	4/3/0
SSP2-4.5	Rx1day	6.1	0.5 to 15.4	0.1 to 31.6	7/0/0
SSP2-4.5	Rx5day	4.2	2.6 to 15.6	–3.6 to 38.2	6/1/0
SSP2-4.5	CDD	–2.1	–3.7 to –0.5	–5.6 to 1.0	1/6/0
SSP2-4.5	CWD	1.5	–3.0 to 8.2	–11.6 to 22.2	4/3/0
SSP2-4.5	R10mm	–0.9	–7.9 to 3.3	–8.6 to 3.9	3/4/0
SSP2-4.5	R20mm	–2.6	–7.9 to 5.6	–13.4 to 11.4	3/4/0
SSP2-4.5	R50mm	24.4	10.1 to 29.3	–5.6 to 87.0	6/1/0
SSP2-4.5	R95p	4.4	0.6 to 15.6	–6.4 to 62.6	5/2/0
SSP2-4.5	R99p	26.7	13.7 to 33.5	0.9 to 196.7	7/0/0
SSP5-8.5	PRCPTOT	0.9	–5.0 to 5.5	–9.9 to 15.3	4/3/0
SSP5-8.5	SDII	–2.4	–4.5 to 3.3	–12.1 to 7.0	3/4/0
SSP5-8.5	Rx1day	12.3	1.7 to 13.8	–10.6 to 23.4	5/2/0

Scenario	Index	Median (%)	IQR (%)	Range (%)	Models +/-0
SSP5-8.5	Rx5day	2.9	-2.0 to 21.5	-8.6 to 31.7	5/2/0
SSP5-8.5	CDD	-0.3	-3.5 to 0.8	-9.5 to 6.8	3/4/0
SSP5-8.5	CWD	1.6	-0.3 to 4.4	-0.5 to 23.7	4/3/0
SSP5-8.5	R10mm	-3.0	-4.3 to 3.0	-13.6 to 5.5	3/4/0
SSP5-8.5	R20mm	-3.1	-11.3 to 4.4	-17.6 to 12.3	2/5/0
SSP5-8.5	R50mm	17.5	-5.3 to 29.3	-20.2 to 64.1	4/3/0
SSP5-8.5	R95p	4.3	-7.3 to 19.5	-21.0 to 42.1	4/3/0
SSP5-8.5	R99p	14.4	-5.5 to 50.5	-17.4 to 127.0	4/3/0

Note: For each model, station-level relative changes were summarized by the station median; the displayed median, IQR, and range were then calculated across the seven model-level values. +/-0 denotes the number of model-level station medians above/below/equal to zero. Undefined R99p relative changes at station 351011 (zero baseline) were excluded, so the within-model R99p median used 12 stations. The ensemble statistics are descriptive and do not assume model independence.

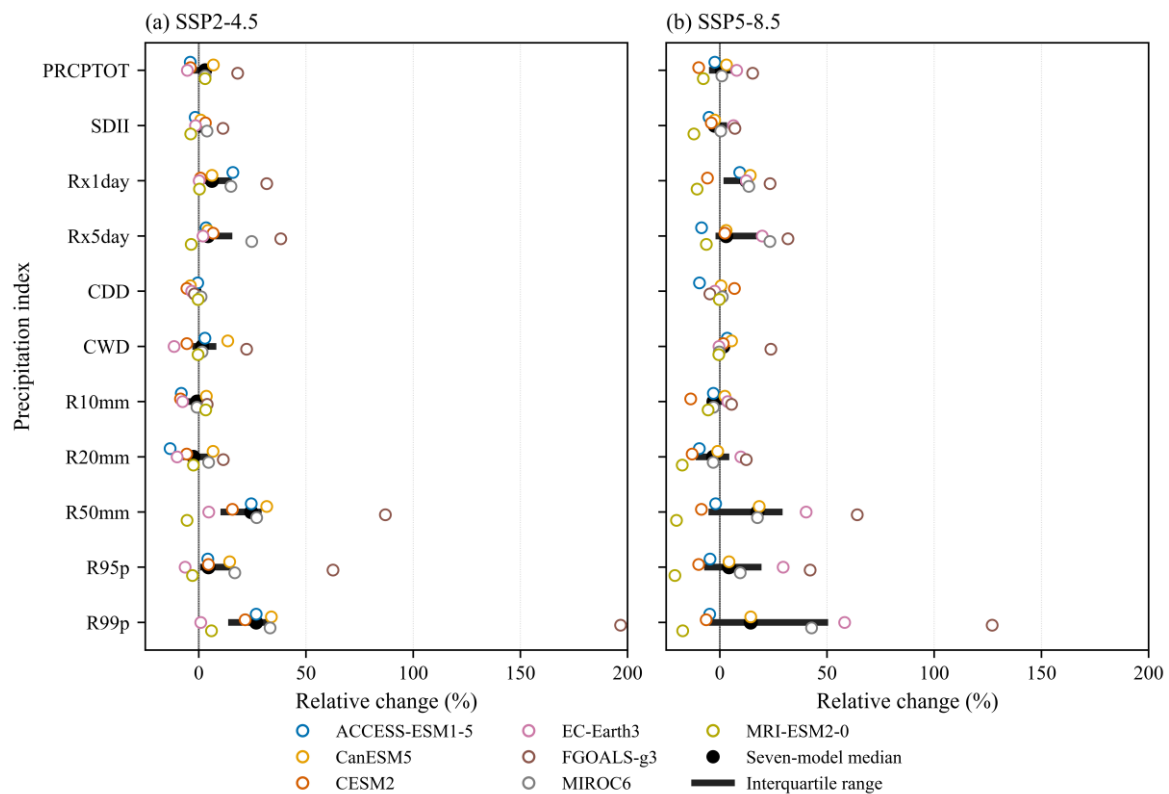


Figure 2. Model-first relative changes in annual precipitation indices for 2021–2050 relative to 1995–2014 under (a) SSP2-4.5 and (b) SSP5-8.5. Each open circle represents one model after its station median was calculated; the black point is the seven-model median and the thick horizontal segment is the interquartile range. A common x-axis permits direct scenario comparison.

3.3 Spatial pattern of projected PRCPTOT change

Station-level ensemble medians showed broadly weak positive PRCPTOT changes under both scenarios (Figure 3). Under SSP2-4.5, 12 of 13 stations were positive and one was negative; station medians ranged from -1.0% to $+3.4\%$. Under SSP5-8.5, 10 stations were positive and three were negative, with a range from -1.7% to $+4.8\%$. The IDW field under SSP2-4.5 was consequently positive across most of the province, with a localized negative pocket near station 351011. Under SSP5-8.5, weak positive values persisted across much of the network, while negative pockets occurred toward the southwestern and eastern station locations and near-neutral values occurred around station 351201.

These fields communicate broad spatial contrast rather than resolved climate dynamics. Station density is lower toward the provincial margins, and the entire northern tip lies outside

the gauge convex hull. The continuous colors in those areas are therefore generated by the IDW distance rule, not by independent observations or model-grid validation. Topography may contribute to real rainfall gradients, but the present analysis did not test an elevation–change relationship. The maps should be used to identify where station-referenced ensemble medians differ, not to assign precise changes at ungauged locations.

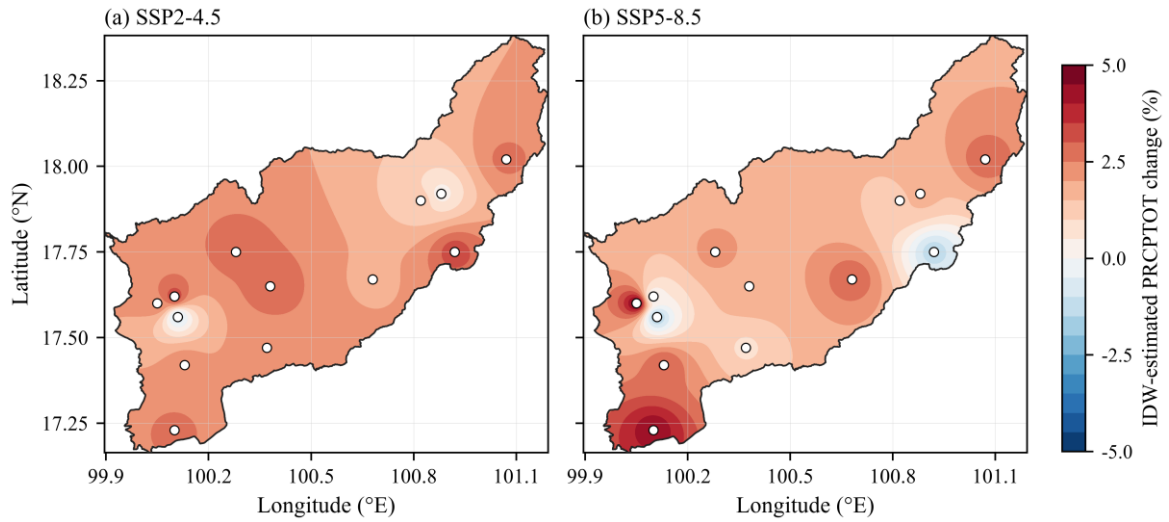


Figure 3. Spatial distribution of projected changes in annual total wet-day precipitation (PRCPTOT) over Uttaradit Province for 2021–2050 relative to 1995–2014 under (a) SSP2-4.5 and (b) SSP5-8.5. IDW with power 2 was applied to station-level seven-model medians, and the same percentage scale was used in both panels. White areas outside the provincial boundary are masked. Areas within the polygon but outside the station convex hull are extrapolations rather than independently validated gridded projections.

3.4 Within-window trend diagnostics

The unadjusted standard MK diagnostic identified significant trends in 79 of 1,001 SSP2-4.5 annual series: five were increasing and 74 decreasing. For SSP5-8.5, 71 of 1,001 series were significant, comprising 57 increases and 14 decreases. These counts concern the slope within 2021–2050 and do not contradict the baseline-to-future changes in Table 5. For example, an index may have a future-period mean above its 1995–2014 baseline while declining within the future window. Because no multiplicity correction was applied to these 2,002 diagnostic tests and each series spans only 30 years, their significance counts were not used to rank scenarios or claim ensemble robustness.

3.5 Implications and limitations

The clearest projected signal is a possible redistribution toward heavier individual events without a comparably robust increase in annual wet-day precipitation. Under SSP2-4.5, unanimous positive model signs for Rx1day and R99p and six-of-seven agreement for Rx5day contrast with the split PRCPTOT response. Under SSP5-8.5, the larger Rx1day median suggests stronger short-duration intensity, but agreement is weaker for most other indices. Similar regional assessments have found that precipitation-total and extreme-event signals can differ and that their magnitudes depend on model and processing choices

(Kuinkel et al., 2024; Nontikansak et al., 2022; Try and Qin, 2024; Zhang et al., 2024). For water management, this pattern means that flood and erosion hazard may intensify even where annual totals change little; realized impacts will also depend on event timing, antecedent moisture, catchment response, drainage capacity, and exposure.

Four limitations constrain interpretation. First, the seven models are a selected, non-independent ensemble, so the median and sign counts do not define probabilities. Second, the supplied bias-corrected series could not be independently audited against complete correction metadata; extremes may be sensitive to choices in wet-day adjustment and temporal sequencing (Cannon et al., 2015; Maraun, 2016; Maraun et al., 2017). Third, relative changes in rare-event indices are unstable when baseline values are small or zero, as shown by the undefined R99p changes at one station and the broad R50mm/R99p ranges. Fourth, IDW represents geographic proximity only and cannot resolve an orographic gradient, convective organization, or model physics absent from the station values. These limitations favor adaptation strategies that are robust to a range of plausible changes rather than optimized to one ensemble median.

4. Conclusions

For 2021–2050 relative to 1995–2014, the seven-model ensemble projected modest and uncertain changes in PRCPTOT but larger median increases in several precipitation extremes. Under SSP2-4.5, median changes were +2.9% for PRCPTOT, +6.1% for Rx1day, +4.2% for Rx5day, and +26.7% for R99p; model sign agreement was strongest for Rx1day and R99p. Under SSP5-8.5, the corresponding medians were +0.9%, +12.3%, +2.9%, and +14.4%, with wider sign disagreement for most indices. The higher forcing pathway therefore intensified the ensemble-median Rx1day response but did not uniformly amplify all indices. PRCPTOT changes were weakly positive at most stations, with localized negative pockets; IDW mapped these station-referenced contrasts but did not provide a validated gridded forecast. Planning should consider the possibility of stronger short-duration and upper-tail rainfall together with substantial inter-model uncertainty and limited information at ungauged locations.

5. Acknowledgments

The author acknowledges the Office of Water Management and Hydrology, Royal Irrigation Department, for institutional support.

6. Author Contributions

S.P.: Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Validation, Formal analysis, Investigation, Data curation, Visualization, Writing—original draft, and Writing—review and editing.

7. Declaration of Competing Interest

The authors declare no conflict of interest.

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